

Domain Reconnaissance report

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1). Introduction.

This report documents a basic reconnaissance exercise performed against the safe public training domain example.com. The purpose of the exercise was to identify publicly available DNS, IP, domain registration, HTTP header and network-path information using standard reconnaissance and network diagnostic tools.

2). Objective.

The objectives of this exercise were:

- To perform basic WHOIS reconnaissance.
- To identify DNS records associated with the target domain.
- To identify the IP address associated with the domain.
- To examine HTTP response headers.
- To observe the network path to the target using traceroute.
- To document the findings in a structured reconnaissance worksheet.

3). Scope and authorization.

The reconnaissance was limited to the safe public training domain `example.com`. Only basic WHOIS, DNS, HTTP header and traceroute queries were performed. No exploitation, vulnerability scanning or intrusive testing was conducted.

4). Tools used.

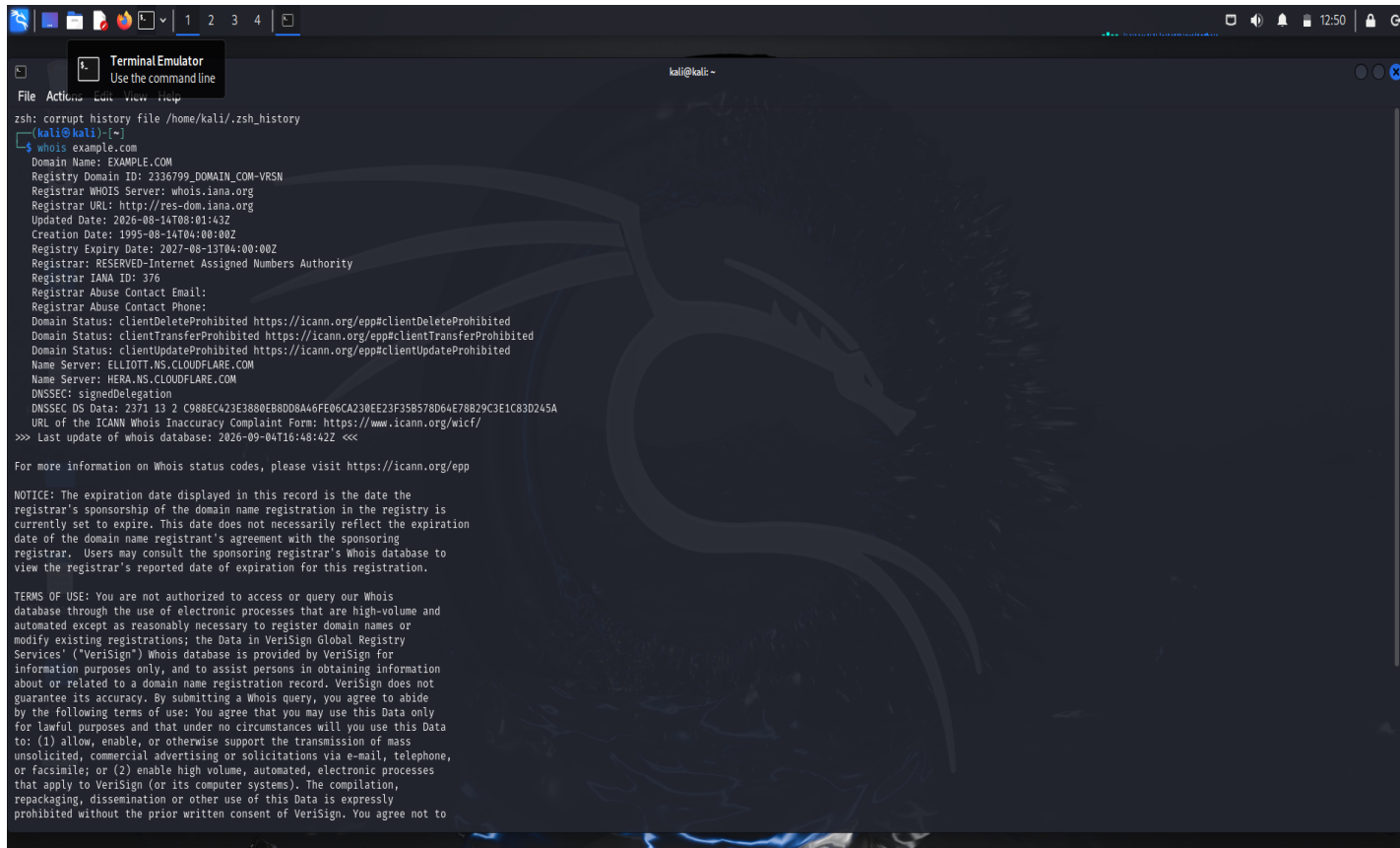
Tool	Purpose
WHOIS	Obtaining domain registration information.
dig	Querying DNS records
nslookup	Performing DNS resolution
Curl	Inspecting HTTP response headers.
tracert	Observing the network path to the destination.
Kali Linux	Operating system.

5). Reconnaissance methodology.

The reconnaissance process consisted of five main stages. First, WHOIS was used to obtain publicly available domain registration information. Second, DNS queries were performed using dig and nslookup to identify IP addresses and DNS records. Third, the HTTP response headers were examined using curl. Finally, traceroute was used to observe the network path between the testing system and the destination.

6). Reconnaissance findings.

6.1) WHOIS findings.



```
zsh: corrupt history file /home/kali/.zsh_history
--(kali@kali)~$
$ whois example.com
Domain Name: EXAMPLE.COM
Registry Domain ID: 2336799_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.iana.org
Registrar URL: http://res-dom.iana.org
Updated Date: 2026-08-14T08:01:43Z
Creation Date: 1995-08-14T04:00:00Z
Registry Expiry Date: 2027-08-13T04:00:00Z
Registrar: RESERVED-Internet Assigned Numbers Authority
Registrar IANA ID: 376
Registrar Abuse Contact Email:
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone:
Domain Status: clientDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: clientTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientTransferProhibited
Domain Status: clientUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientUpdateProhibited
Name Server: ELLIOTT.NS.CLOUDFLARE.COM
Name Server: HERA.NS.CLOUDFLARE.COM
DNSSEC: signedDelegation
DNSSEC DS Data: 2371 13 2 C988EC423E3880EB8D08A46FE06CA230EE23F35B578D64E78B29C3E1C83D245A
URL of the ICANN Whois Inaccuracy Complaint Form: https://www.icann.org/wicf/
>>> Last update of whois database: 2026-09-04T16:48:42Z <<<

For more information on Whois status codes, please visit https://icann.org/epp

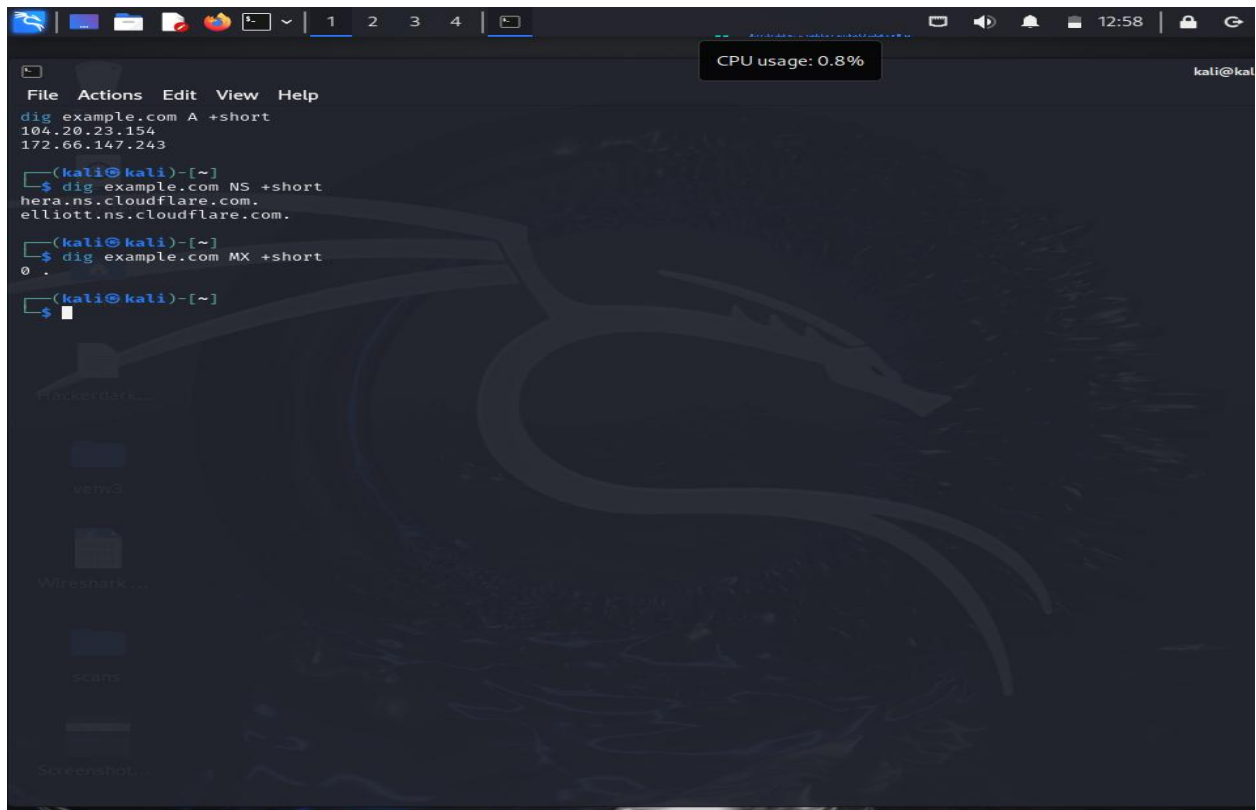
NOTICE: The expiration date displayed in this record is the date the
registrar's sponsorship of the domain name registration in the registry is
currently set to expire. This date does not necessarily reflect the expiration
date of the domain name registrant's agreement with the sponsoring
registrar. Users may consult the sponsoring registrar's Whois database to
view the registrar's reported date of expiration for this registration.

TERMS OF USE: You are not authorized to access or query our Whois
database through the use of electronic processes that are high-volume and
automated except as reasonably necessary to register domain names or
modify existing registrations; the Data in VeriSign Global Registry
Services' ('VeriSign') Whois database is provided by VeriSign for
information purposes only, and to assist persons in obtaining information
about or related to a domain name registration record. VeriSign does not
guarantee its accuracy. By submitting a Whois query, you agree to abide
by the following terms of use: You agree that you may use this Data only
for lawful purposes and that under no circumstances will you use this Data
to: (1) allow, enable, or otherwise support the transmission of mass
unsolicited, commercial advertising or solicitations via e-mail, telephone,
or facsimile; or (2) enable high volume, automated, electronic processes
that apply to VeriSign (or its computer systems). The compilation,
repackaging, dissemination or other use of this Data is expressly
prohibited without the prior written consent of VeriSign. You agree not to
```

The command `whois example.com` was used to retrieve publicly available domain registration information.

The results provided information related to the domain registration and name server configuration.

6.2). DNS findings.

A screenshot of a Kali Linux terminal window. The terminal has a dark background with a large, faint dragon logo in the center. The terminal output shows the results of three dig commands. The first command is 'dig example.com A +short', which returns two IP addresses: 104.20.23.154 and 172.66.147.243. The second command is '\$ dig example.com NS +short', which returns two name servers: hera.ns.cloudflare.com and elliot.ns.cloudflare.com. The third command is '\$ dig example.com MX +short', which returns '0'. The terminal window has a menu bar with 'File', 'Actions', 'Edit', 'View', and 'Help'. The status bar at the top shows 'CPU usage: 0.8%' and the user 'kali@kali'. The desktop background is dark with a dragon logo. There are several icons on the left side of the desktop, including 'Documents', 'Downloads', 'Kali Linux', 'Wireshark', 'Kali Linux', 'Kali Linux', and 'Screenshot'.

The dig command was used to identify DNS records associated with the target.

The A record returned the following IP address:

Ip Address: 104.20.23.154

Ip address: 172.66.147.243

The NS query identified the following name servers:

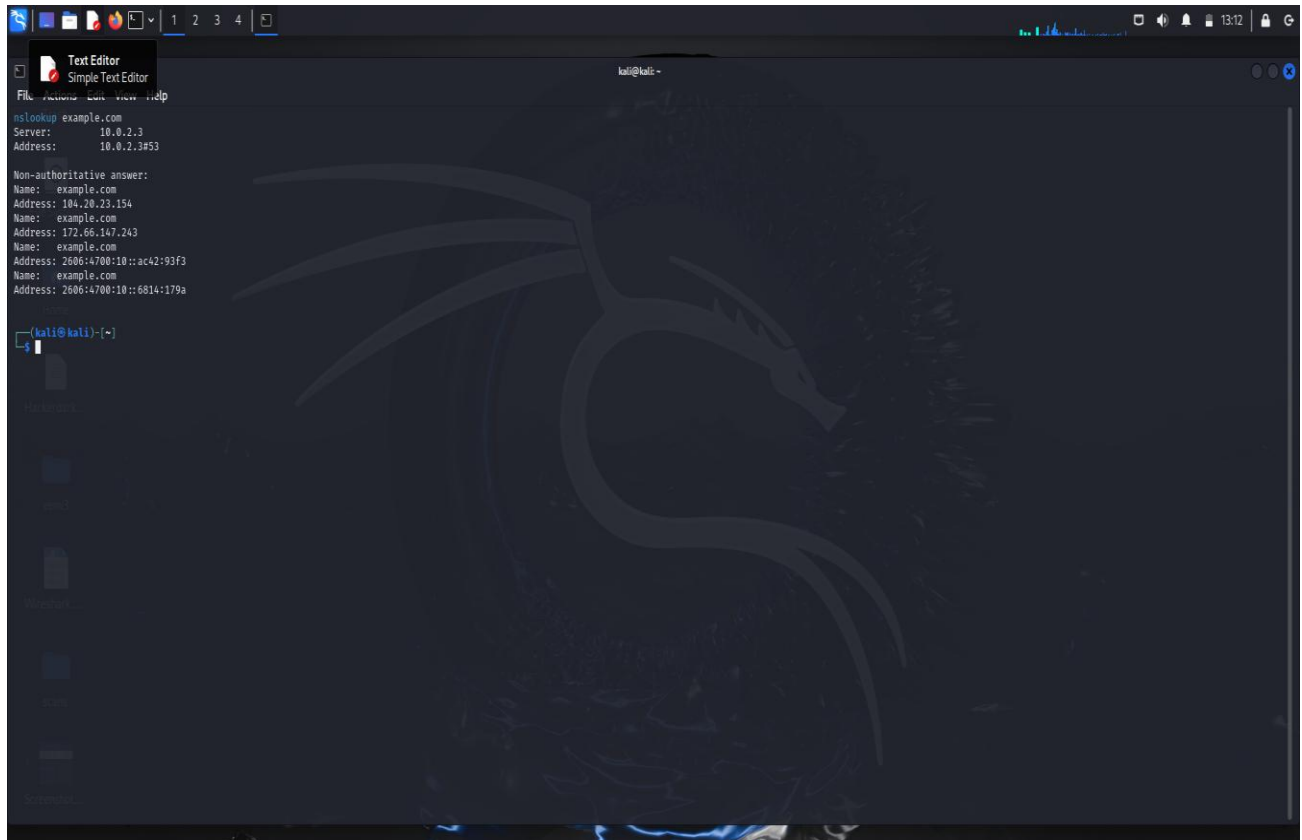
Name servers: hera.ns.cloudflare.com

Name servers: Elliot.ns.cloudflare.com

The MX query returned:

Mail Exchange : none

6.3). Ip address findings.

A screenshot of a Kali Linux desktop environment. The desktop background features a large, stylized dragon logo. In the foreground, a terminal window is open, displaying the output of an 'nslookup example.com' command. The terminal shows the server IP as 10.0.2.3 and lists several IP addresses for the domain example.com, including 104.20.23.154, 172.66.147.249, and two IPv6 addresses. A text editor window titled 'Text Editor' is also visible in the top-left corner.

```
kali@kali ~  
nslookup example.com  
Server:      10.0.2.3  
Address:     10.0.2.3#53  
  
Non-authoritative answer:  
Name:   example.com  
Address: 104.20.23.154  
Name:   example.com  
Address: 172.66.147.249  
Name:   example.com  
Address: 2006:4700:18::ac42:93f3  
Name:   example.com  
Address: 2006:4700:18::6814:179a  
  
(kali@kali)~$
```

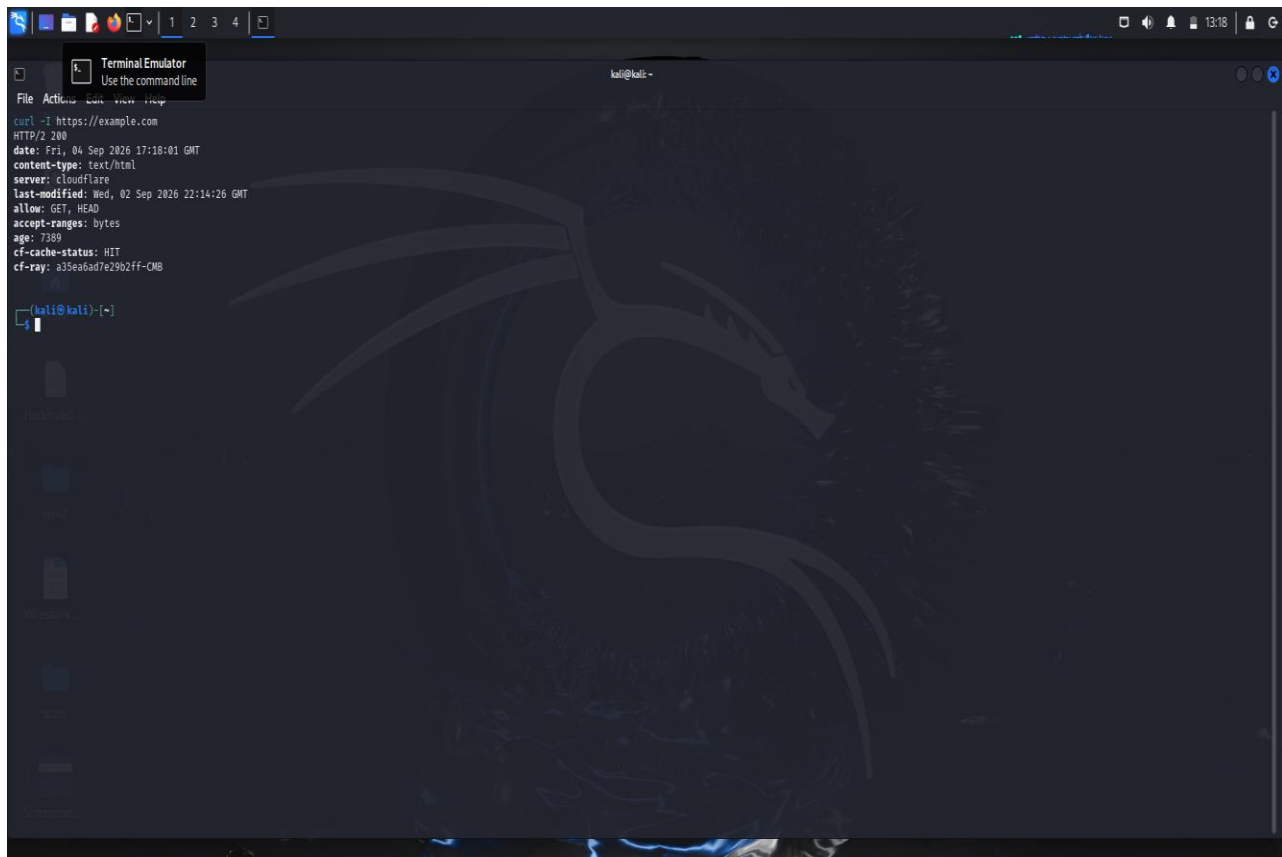
DNS resolution confirmed that example.com resolves to the IP address identified above.

The IP address was obtained using:

dig example.com A +short

The same domain was also tested using nslookup example.com to confirm DNS resolution.

6.4). HTTP header findings.

A screenshot of a Kali Linux desktop environment. The terminal window is open, showing the command `curl -I https://example.com` and its output. The output displays HTTP response headers including status, date, content-type, server, last-modified, allow, accept-ranges, age, cf-cache-status, and cf-ray. A large, faint dragon logo is visible in the background of the terminal window.

```
kali@kali:~$ curl -I https://example.com
HTTP/2 200
date: Fri, 04 Sep 2026 17:18:01 GMT
content-type: text/html
server: cloudflare
last-modified: Wed, 02 Sep 2026 22:14:26 GMT
allow: GET, HEAD
accept-ranges: bytes
age: 7389
cf-cache-status: HIT
cf-ray: a39ea6ad7e29d2ff-CMB

kali@kali:~$
```

The command `curl -I https://example.com` was used to inspect the HTTP response headers.

The HTTP response status was:

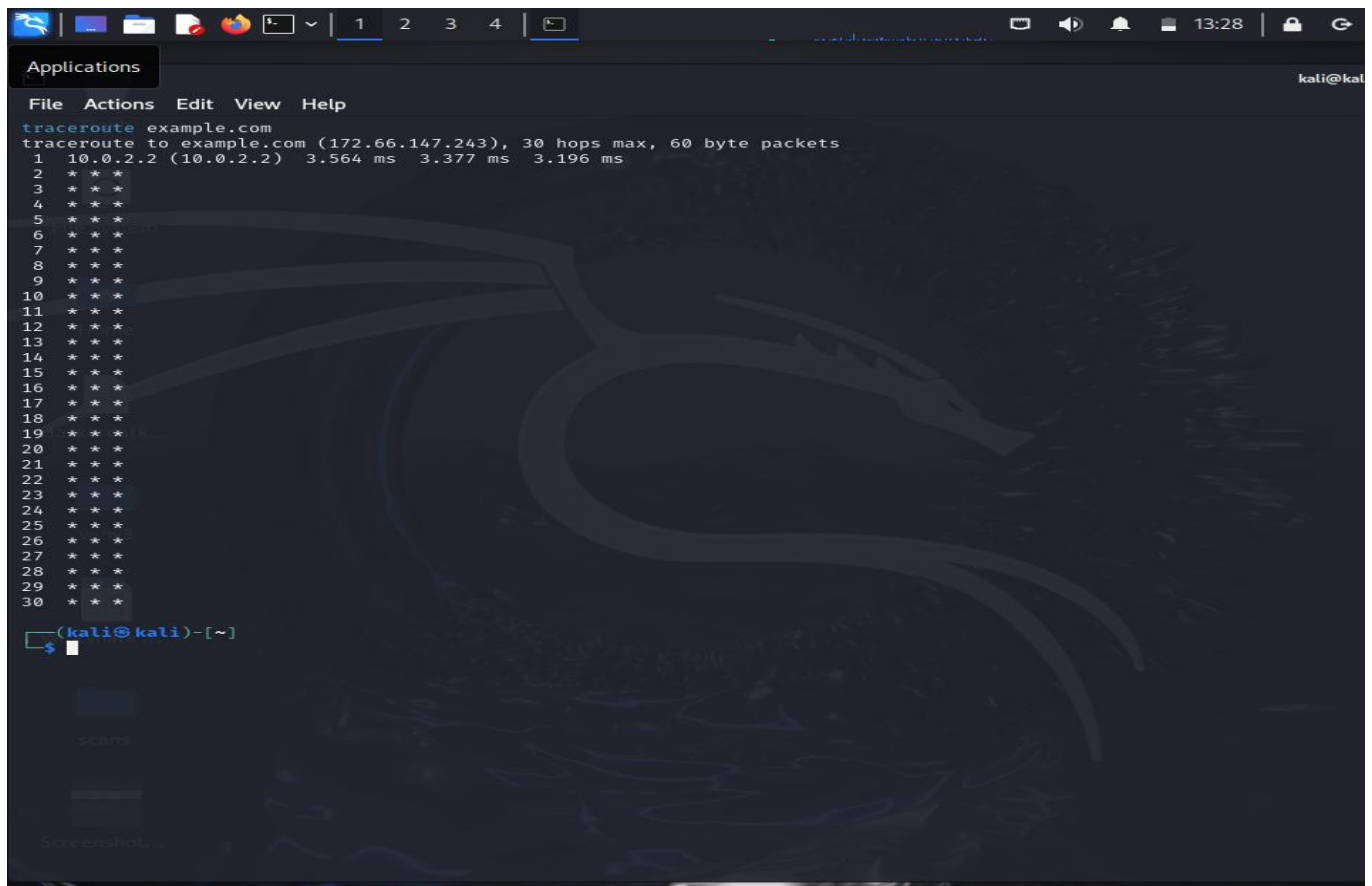
Status: HTTP/2 200

Important headers observed included:

- Content-type : text/html
- Server: cloudflare
- Last-modified : Wed, 02 Sep 2026
- Accept-ranges: bytes
- Cf-cache-status: HIT

These headers provide basic information about how the web server responds to HTTP requests.

6.5). Traceroute findings.



```
Applications
File Actions Edit View Help
traceroute example.com
traceroute to example.com (172.66.147.243), 30 hops max, 60 byte packets
 1  10.0.2.2 (10.0.2.2)  3.564 ms  3.377 ms  3.196 ms
 2  * * *
 3  * * *
 4  * * *
 5  * * *
 6  * * *
 7  * * *
 8  * * *
 9  * * *
10  * * *
11  * * *
12  * * *
13  * * *
14  * * *
15  * * *
16  * * *
17  * * *
18  * * *
19  * * *
20  * * *
21  * * *
22  * * *
23  * * *
24  * * *
25  * * *
26  * * *
27  * * *
28  * * *
29  * * *
30  * * *

(kali@kali)-[~]
$
```

The traceroute example.com command was used to observe the network path between the Kali Linux system and the target.

The traceroute output displayed single network hops. Some hops may not respond because routers can block or deprioritize traceroute probes.

7). Reconnaissance worksheet.

Category	Tool	Finding
Domain information	WHOIS	Registration information identified.
Target		example.com
IPv4 address	dig	104.20.23.154 / 172.66.147.243
Name servers	dig	hera.ns.cloudflare.com/ Elliot.ns.cloudflare.com
Mail servers	dig	none
TXT records dig	dig	-
DNS resolution	nslookup	Resolution confirmed
HTTPS status	curl	HTTP/2 200
HTTP headers		• Content-type : text/html • Server: cloudfare • Last-modified : Wed, 02 Sep 2026 • Accept-ranges: bytes • Cf-cache-status: HIT
Network path	tracert	Single hops observed.

8). Conclusion.

The reconnaissance exercise successfully demonstrated the use of basic information-gathering and network diagnostic tools. WHOIS provided domain registration information, while dig and nslookup were used to identify DNS information and IP addresses. curl was used to examine HTTP response headers, and traceroute was used to observe the network path to the destination.

The exercise demonstrates how publicly available information can be collected and organized during the initial reconnaissance stage of a cybersecurity assessment. No exploitation or intrusive activity was performed.

